FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

What's in the Playlist — AutoMix improv tips, Playlist Check answer key, real-world debrief guide, and exit ticket exemplars.

WHY THIS LESSON

Students usually hear "AI is biased" as "somebody made it mean." This lesson swaps the villain for a mechanism: **input → patterns → output**. Once a student has personally failed Tomás because their playlist held no Spanish tracks, "biased training data" stops being vocabulary and becomes something they *did* — and know how to fix. One question then transfers to every AI tool they'll ever meet: **what's in the playlist?**

PLAYING THE ONE-PLAYLIST APP

Three moves carry the bit: **serve with total confidence** (the app has no idea it's failing — never apologize), **announce the track like it's exactly right** ("Grandma's birthday? VOLUME WAR."), and **upgrade nothing** — a slow-song request gets the same tempo, cheerfully. Keep it to 3–4 requests so the joke lands and moves. The gold moment: a student says the playlist is the problem, not the app. Hand them the imaginary aux cord — they just said the thesis of the lesson out loud.

ANSWER KEY — SERVE THE REQUEST LINE

"Best card" can vary; the fit ratings shouldn't drift far from these:

REQUEST	STRONG PICKS	EXPECTED FIT
Keisha — tunnel-walk anthem	Full Court Press, Crowd Goes Wild	Nailed it
Nia — calm study music	Cool Down (Kinda)	Close-ish at best — still a party track
Tomás — song in Spanish	Any card (the app must serve)	Can't do it — zero Spanish tracks
Priya — slow last-dance song	Cool Down (Kinda)	Can't do it — medium is not slow
Malik — party opener	Thunder Mode, Bass Quake, Confetti Cannon	Nailed it
Jordan — quiet acoustic track	Any card	Can't do it — nothing quiet exists
Live request	Varies	Ask: what did the playlist do to it?

SCORING THE GAP REPORT & DOCTOR THE PLAYLIST

- **Proficient:** names WHO is served and left out (people, not just song types); the 3 new cards target different gaps (tempo, language, style).
- **Developing:** names missing song types but not the people behind the requests; new cards fix one gap three times.
- **Beginning:** "the playlist needs more songs," with no who and no what.

EXEMPLARS & SENTENCE FRAMES

Say back + build frames (support / ELL): "I heard you say ____." · "Building on that, ____." · "This playlist serves ____ but not ____." Overwhelmed by 12 cards? Pre-circle Cool Down (Kinda) and the three Gym tracks as landmarks.

Doctor the Playlist exemplars: "Luna Lullaby — acoustic ballad · slow · study" / "Cumbia del Cumpleaños — cumbia · medium · family party, Spanish lyrics" / "Porch Strings — folk · quiet · sing-along." Three cards, three different gaps.

Exit Ticket 1: "INPUT → PATTERNS → OUTPUT. The AI studies its playlist of examples, learns what usually goes with what, and answers by predicting what matches those patterns. It doesn't understand — it predicts."

Exit Ticket 2: "Whoever filled its playlist used football examples, so football patterns are all it can serve. Students whose interests never made the playlist get worse help than everyone else."

THE REAL PLAYLISTS — DEBRIEF GUIDE

Voice assistants: they understand best the voices that filled their training audio. Less-common accents, kids' voices, and speech differences get misheard more often — an accessibility gap that traces straight back to the playlist.

Photo tools: face-detection features have historically worked worse on darker skin tones when training photos leaned lighter — and improved when companies rebuilt their datasets. The fix for a playlist problem is fixing the playlist.

Your feed: a recommendation feed's playlist is your watch history. One-genre history, one-genre feed — the same mechanism, running in students' pockets right now.

"Did someone do this on purpose?" Usually not. Teams collect the data that's easiest to get, and easy data leans toward whoever is already over-represented. No villain required — which is why real AI teams audit their playlists before shipping. If a student asks **"isn't AI creative, though?"** — it can mash up playlist patterns into combos nobody put in, but it can't mash up a genre it has never heard.

Handle with care: some students in the room are the people these gaps mishear or mislabel. Keep the frame "the playlist failed them, and playlists can be fixed" — never "the tech doesn't like you."

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-21** — Discuss issues of bias and accessibility in the design of existing technologies. *Taught: Playlist Check gap-mapping + Real Playlists debrief. Assessed: Playlist Gap Report + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.1.d** — Students understand the fundamental concepts of technology operations, demonstrate the ability to choose, use and troubleshoot current technologies and are able to transfer their knowledge to explore emerging technologies. *Taught: No Magic in the Machine (input → patterns → output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1, transfer in Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA SL.6.1** — Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade 6 topics, texts, and issues, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly. *Taught: say-back-and-build rule in Playlist Check step 3. Assessed: "Say back + build" worksheet item.*

THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

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